

LEONTOPODIUM

Edelweiss

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of short-lived, spring-flowering, woolly perennials, grown for their distinctive flower heads. Suitable for rock gardens, containers, and alpine troughs. Fully hardy. Requires sun, gritty, well-drained soil, and a deep collar of grit to improve surface drainage. Shelter from prevailing, rain-bearing winds, because the crowns are extremely intolerant of winter wet and may rot off. Propagate by division in spring, or by seed when fresh. Many seeds are not viable.

L. alpinum. See *L. nivale* subsp. *alpinum*. **L. nivale** subsp. *alpinum*, syn. *L. alpinum* (Edelweiss), illus. p.332.

L. stracheyi. Mound-forming, spreading, woolly perennial. H to 20in (50cm), 5 to 1ft (30cm). Star-shaped, glistening, yellowish white flower heads are produced among thick, ovate, silver leaves in spring. A good plant for an alpine house. Z4–9

Leopoldia comosa. See *Muscari comosum*.

LEPISMIUM

CACTACEAE

Genus of epiphytic and lithophytic (growing on rocks) perennial cacti often pendulous in habit with cylindrical, ribbed, angled, or flat, usually segmented stems. Small, funnel- to disk-shaped flowers are followed by spherical, often purple or red berries. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and rich, well-drained soil. Prefers 80% relative humidity—higher than for most cacti. Give only occasional, very light watering in winter. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

L. warmingianum, syn. *Rhipsalis warmingiana*. Erect, then pendent, perennial cactus. H 3ft (1m), 5 20in (50cm). Has slender, notched, cylindrical, green branches, sometimes tinged red or brown, with 2–4 angles, and green-white flowers in winter and spring, followed by violet berries. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

LEPTINELLA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals and creeping perennials that are effective as low groundcover. Fully hardy. Grow in full sun and sharply drained, moderately fertile soil. Propagate by seed when ripe or by division in spring. **L. atrata**, syn. *Cotula atrata*. Evergreen, creeping, tufted perennial. H to 6in (15cm), 5 to 8in (20cm). Has small, finely cut, grayish-green leaves and bears blackish-red flower heads in late spring and early summer. Not easy to grow successfully. Z9–10. **subsp. luteola** illus. p.349.

LEPTOSPERMUM

MYRTACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage and small, often profuse flowers. Grows well in coastal areas if not too exposed. Borderline fully hardy to frost tender; in cold areas best

bears dense, ovoid-oblong spikes, to 1¼in (3cm) long, of dark purple flowers, topped by conspicuous purple bracts that fade to pink. Z5–9

L. x gingsilii ‘Goodwin Creek Grey’. Evergreen, vigorous, compact shrub. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), 5 3ft (90cm). Has linear-oblong, toothed, aromatic, silvery gray leaves. Short stems bear dense spikes, to 4in (10cm) long or more, of fragrant, soft lavender-blue flowers in summer and early fall. Z5–9

L. ‘Helmsdale’ (illus. p.158). Evergreen, compact, bushy shrub. H and S 28in (70cm). Has linear, aromatic, gray-green leaves. Ovoid-oblong spikes, to 1¼in (3cm) long, bear fragrant, dark purple flowers, topped by conspicuous burgundy-red bracts from late spring to summer. Z5–9 **L. ‘Hidcote’.** See *L. angustifolia* ‘Hidcote’.

L. x intermedia (English lavender, Lavandin). Evergreen, spreading shrub. H and S 12–20in (30–50cm). Has oblong to lance-shaped to almost spoon-shaped, very aromatic, gray-green leaves, covered in fine, silvery-gray hairs. In summer, light blue to violet flowers are borne in spikes 4–8in (10–20cm) long. The main source of commercial lavender, lavandine. Z5–9. **‘Alba’** (illus. p.158) is a vigorous, erect shrub with white flowers, occasionally tinted pale purple. **‘Hidcote Giant’**, H 2½ft–3ft (75–100cm), 5 3ft (1m), has dense spikes of violet-blue flowers; excellent for cutting. **Old English Group.** H to 20in (50cm), has purple flowers borne on long, erect stems.

L. lanata (illus. p.158). Evergreen, bushy shrub. H 2½ft (75cm), 5 3ft (90cm). Young shoots and linear leaves are covered with whitish “wool.” Bears dense spikes, to 4in (10cm) long, of fragrant, dark purple flowers on unbranched stems in late summer. Z9–11

L. pedunculata. Evergreen, erect shrub. H and S 20–32in (50–80cm). Has linear, gray-green leaves, and bears ovoid, densely felted flower spikes, ¾–1½in (2–4cm) long, topped by 4–6 purplish violet, sterile bracts on stalks, 1ft (30cm) long, in summer. Z9–11. **subsp. pedunculata** (syn. *L. stoechas* subsp. *pedunculata*) has violet-blue apical bracts with red-purple mid-ribs.

subsp. pedunculata ‘James Compton’ (illus. p.158) has purple-margined, green stalks and very dark purple apical bracts. **L. ‘Pretty Polly’.** Evergreen, compact shrub. H and S 16in (40cm). Has linear, aromatic, gray-green leaves. In late spring and summer, bears dense, ovoid-oblong flower spikes, to 1¼in (3cm) long, of fragrant, purple-blue flowers, topped by white bracts that are veined green. Z4–9 **L. ‘Regal Splendour’** (illus. p.158).

Evergreen, vigorous, erect shrub. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), 5 1–2ft (30–60cm). Has linear, aromatic, gray-green leaves. In late spring and summer, bears dense, ovoid-oblong flower spikes, to 1in (2.5cm) long, of fragrant, rich violet-blue flowers, topped by wavy-edged, purple-violet bracts, on stalks to 5in (12cm) long. Z8–10

L. stoechas (French lavender; illus. p.158). Evergreen, compact, bushy shrub. H and S 2ft (60cm). Has linear, gray-green leaves. Fragrant, dark purple flowers, with purple bracts, are borne in dense, ovoid-

oblong spikes, to 1¼in (3cm) long, on short, unbranched stalks, to 1¼in (3cm) long, from late spring to summer. Z6–10. **subsp. pedunculata** see *L. pedunculata* subsp. *pedunculata*. **subsp. stoechas f. leucantha** is vigorous, with short spikes of white flowers topped with white bracts. **subsp. stoechas f. leucantha ‘Snowman’** (illus. p.158) is similar, but more compact. **subsp. stoechas f. rosea** produces pink to rose-red flowers with reddish-purple bracts. **subsp. stoechas f. rosea ‘Kew Red’** (illus. p.158), H and S 1½ft (45cm), is compact and upright, producing spikes of bright cerise-purple flowers, topped by pale purple bracts. **L. ‘Willow Vale’** (illus. p.158). Evergreen, vigorous, upright shrub. H 2½ft (75cm), 5 2ft (60cm). Has linear, aromatic yellow-green to gray leaves. In late spring and summer, erect stems bear dense spikes, to 1¼in (3cm) long, of fragrant, deep violet flowers, topped by reddish purple bracts. Z7–9

LAVATERA

Tree mallow

MALVACEAE

Genus of mainly summer-flowering annuals, biennials, perennials, and semievergreen subshrubs and shrubs. Fully to frost hardy. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate perennials, subshrubs, and shrubs by softwood cuttings in early spring or summer, annuals and biennials by seed in spring or early fall.

L. assurgentiflora illus. p.133. **L. cachemiriana**, syn. *L. cachemirica*. Semievergreen, woody-based perennial or subshrub. H to 8ft (2.5m), 5 to 34ft (1.2m). Has wiry stems bearing panicles of trumpet-shaped, silky, clear pink flowers in summer and ivy-shaped, downy, mid-green leaves. Z7–10

L. cachemirica. See *L. cachemiriana*. **L. x clementii ‘Barnsley’.** Vigorous, semievergreen subshrub. H and S 3–6ft (1–2m). Mid-green, palmate leaves have 3–5 lobes. Throughout summer bears profuse racemes of open funnel-shaped, red-eyed, white flowers, aging to soft pink, with deeply notched petals. Z7–10. **‘Bredon Springs’** produces mauve-flushed, dusky pink flowers. **‘Burgundy Wine’** produces rich dark pink flowers with darker veins. **‘Candy Floss’** bears pale pink flowers throughout summer. **‘Rosea’** (syn. *L. olbia* ‘Rosea’) illus. p.136.

L. olbia ‘Rosea’. See *L. x clementii* ‘Rosea’. **L. trimestris ‘Novella Hot Pink’.** Compact and branching annual. H 20in (50cm), 5 1ft (30cm). Produces shallowly trumpet-shaped, rose-pink flowers above deep green leaves in summer. Excellent for growing in containers. H5. **‘Mont Blanc’** is compact, with very dark green foliage and white flowers. **‘Silver Cup’** illus. p.305.

LAYIA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals, grown for their daisylike flowers, borne profusely in summer. Useful for a hot, dry site.

Fully hardy to half hardy. Grow in sun and in poor to fertile, very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown outdoors in spring or early fall.

L. elegans. See *L. platyglossa*. **L. platyglossa**, syn. *L. elegans* (Tidy tips). Fast-growing, upright, bushy annual. H 1½ft (45cm), 5 1ft (30cm). Has lance-shaped, grayish-green leaves. Daisylike flower heads, 2in (5cm) across, with white-tipped, yellow ray petals and yellow centers, are produced from early summer to early fall. Suitable for cutting. Z7–10

Lechenaultia. See *Leschenaultia*.

LEDEBOURIA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of deciduous, evergreen or semievergreen bulbs grown for their attractively marked, ornamental, narrowly lance-shaped leaves and their racemes of small, bell- or urn-shaped flowers, that are reminiscent of lily-of-the-valley (*Convallaria*). Good pot plants for a cool greenhouse. Frost hardy to frost tender. Needs full light, to allow leaf marks to develop well, and loose, open soil. Propagate by offsets in spring.

L. cooperi, syn. *Scilla adlamii*, *S. cooperi*. Deciduous, very variable bulb. H 2–8in (5–20cm), 5 2in (5cm). Semierect, basal, mid- to dark green leaves, with bold purple stripes, die away in winter. In summer, bears racemes of up to 50 bell-shaped, small purple-pink flowers, tipped or striped green. Z10–11 **L. socialis**, syn. *L.s.* var. *violacea*, *Scilla violacea*, illus. p.421.

Ledum groenlandicum. See *Rhododendron groenlandicum*. **Leiophyllum buxifolium.** See *almia buxifolia*.

Lemaireocereus euphorbioides. See *Neobuxbaumia euphorbioides*.

Lemaireocereus marginatus. See *Pachycereus marginatus*.

Lemaireocereus thurberi. See *Stenocereus thurberi*.

Lemboglossum bictoniense. See *Rhynchostele bictoniensis*.

Lemboglossum cervantesii. See *Rhynchostele cervantesii*.

Lemboglossum cordatum. See *Rhynchostele cordata*.

Lemboglossum rossii. See *Rhynchostele rossii*.

Lembotropis nigricans. See *Cytisus nigricans*.

LEONOTIS

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of annuals, evergreen and semievergreen perennials, subshrubs, and shrubs, grown for their flowers and overall appearance. Half hardy. Needs full sun and rich, well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely when in full growth, much less at other times of year. Cut back perennials, subshrubs, and shrubs to within 6in (15cm) of the ground in early spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by greenwood cuttings taken in early summer.

L. leonurus (Lion’s ear) illus. p.141.